BUSINESS AI STACK · CHAPTER 29

Jira

A practical guide with steps, examples and a checklist. Read the chapter, then build the example.

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Jira: tracking product and development work

Jira is a work-tracking tool used by product and engineering teams. It keeps the backlog, the sprint plan and the status of each item in one place.

The Jira hierarchy

- **Epic.** A large goal, for example "Customer enquiry dashboard".
- **Story.** A user-facing piece of work: "As a counsellor, I can see new enquiries first".
- **Task and bug.** The technical steps and defects behind a story.
- **Sprint.** A time-boxed set of stories, usually two weeks.

Set up a project in 30 minutes

1. Create a Scrum or Kanban project. Scrum suits fixed sprints; Kanban suits continuous flow.
2. Set the workflow: To do, In progress, In review, Done. Keep it to four or five statuses.
3. Write each story with a clear acceptance criterion: "Given a new enquiry, when it is saved, then the counsellor sees it within one minute."
4. Estimate in story points, plan one sprint, and review the board every day in a 15-minute stand-up.

Connecting Jira to the rest of the stack

Link commits and pull requests from GitHub to the Jira issue key (for example `SN-42`), so every change is traceable. Automation rules can move an issue when its pull request is merged.

> **GOOD HABIT**
> Keep the backlog short and prioritised. A backlog of 300 untriaged items is not a plan; it is a list of things nobody will do.

Checklist

- Every story has an owner and acceptance criteria.
- The sprint goal is one sentence.
- Done means done: tested, reviewed and deployed.

Reference: Atlassian's Jira documentation for project setup, workflows and automation rules.